```
# Create the backup directory if it doesn't exist.

mkdir -p "$BACKUP_DIR"

# Create a compressed archive of the media files.

tar -czf "$ARCHIVE_FILE" -C "$SOURCE_DIR" .

# Optionally, delete the archived files from the source directory after archiving.

# rm -rf "$SOURCE_DIR"/*

echo "Images archived to $ARCHIVE_FILE"
```

This above script does the following:

It sets the source directory as your media directory and the backup directory where the archives will be stored.

- It generates a timestamp to ensure that backup filenames are unique.